

FIT for FAIR – Cross-Country Insights on Operationalising EU Due Diligence Regulations

Session 3: Regional Exchange in Southeast Asia on the operationalisation of European Due Diligence Legislation for Agricultural Value Chains

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Executive Summary

The technical exchange (11 May 2026) examined how Thailand, Indonesia, Malaysia, Ethiopia and partners are operationalising the EUDR and CSDDD in palm oil, rubber, timber and coffee.

Core message: technology-enabled traceability is necessary but insufficient without strong governance, legal clarity on land tenure, and deliberate inclusion of smallholders and intermediaries.

Thailand is building a national EUDR Single Window and traceability platform; Indonesia's mature, mandatory SVLK shows the value of separated functions, third-party verification and civil-society monitoring; Malaysia's MSPO progress highlights the pivotal role of traders/dealers; Ethiopia's QR-linked Producer IDs demonstrate low-tech inclusion.

Across sessions, unresolved issues are data ownership/governance/privacy and converting informal-sector information into data usable by EU operators.

This report summarises the key findings of the technical exchange convened by ITC with Thai National Bureau of Agricultural Commodity and Food Standards (ACFS) and Thai Environmental Institute (TEI), as part of the FIT for FAIR project, with the support of Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) in Thailand. The webinar brought together 61 registered participants from Thailand, Indonesia, Malaysia, Vietnam, Ethiopia and Europe — from government bodies, the private sector, academia, civil society and development partners — around three main sessions: national traceability platform presentations, a regional expert panel, and parallel breakout discussions.

Key takeaways

- **Governance is the primary challenge, not technology.** Robust traceability depends on clear actor mapping, separated functions defined by binding regulation, cross-ministerial coordination, accreditation mechanisms and independent verification — Indonesia's SVLK was repeatedly cited as the reference case. High-level MOUs alone are insufficient without operational engagement of technical teams inside government.
- **Smallholders and intermediaries determine whether systems work in practice.** Across timber, palm oil, coffee and rubber, smallholders account for the largest share of unmapped, untraced production. Group certification (MSPO clusters), cooperative trade channels (RAOT) and verified producer-ID approaches (Ethiopia) are practical responses, but all still require plot-level mapping to meet the EUDR threshold. Land-tenure complexity — informal occupation, family-owned land, customary tenure — makes legality harder to demonstrate than capturing coordinates. Equally decisive is the inclusion of intermediaries: traders and dealers controlling up to 90 % of smallholder volume in Malaysian palm oil can undermine a strong technical system if they remain outside it; mandatory MSPO certification for them from 2025 was identified as a turning point.
- **Data ownership, governance and privacy are unresolved cross-cutting issues.** Breakout Room 2 was explicit: interoperability will not be achieved without first answering who owns the data, who governs it, who can access it, and how privacy is protected.

- **Regional experience is genuinely transferable.** Indonesia's SVLK, Malaysia's MSPO and Ethiopia's ECTMS each offer fresh ideas and practical impulses for Thailand. The same principles — inclusiveness, no-one-size-fits-all differentiation, independent verification and clear institutional architecture — recurred across all three.

1. Opening Remarks

Opening remarks by **Dr. Inti Schubert (GIZ FIT for FAIR)** framed the EUDR and CSDDD as a reshaping of global supply chains: products on the EU market must be both deforestation-free and respectful of human rights, land tenure and safe working conditions. Reliable data is the backbone, but the harder questions are who collects it, who owns it, and how smallholders are kept from being excluded by cost or lack of digital access. **Dr. Nantaprapa Nantiyakul (ACFS, Thailand)** then positioned Thailand's response within the country's Bio–Circular–Green agenda, describing coordinated action across more than thirty agencies, a new National Committee on EUDR, a National Policy Framework and Plan of Action, and the National EUDR Single Window linking geolocation and traceability data across the supply chain.

“Being FIT for FAIR means building transparency that is just, accessible and locally grounded.”

— Dr. Inti Schubert, GIZ FIT for FAIR Programme

2. National traceability platform presentations

Two national systems were presented: the **Thailand National Traceability Platform** (Dr. Theeraya Mayakul, Faculty of Engineering, Mahidol University) and **Indonesia's SVLK — Sistem Verifikasi Legalitas dan Kelestarian** (Mr. Fery Heriyadi, Ministry of Forestry of the Republic of Indonesia, presenting on behalf of Dr. Tony Rianto, with slide-sharing support from Ms. Candra Rachmawati).

Key findings

- **Both systems are explicitly designed around EUDR data requirements** — geolocation polygons, supplier profiles, chain of custody, product information — with built-in integration to government datasets that verify plot legality.
- **The Thai platform is at the design and build stage.** It is cloud-based, integrates with the Department of Agriculture, generates simplified due-diligence reports and geojson files for EU operators, and adds risk-assessment and mitigation functions despite Thailand's low-risk EUDR classification. It has not yet been tested directly with EU operators; the team is working with Thai exporters that have committed to using its data for EU shipments.
- **Indonesia's SVLK is a mature, mandatory, third-party-verified system.** In operation since 2009 and elevated in 2021 (Government Regulation No. 23/2021) to include sustainability indicators, it rests on ISO/IEC 17065 with clearly separated roles: the Ministry of Forestry as regulator, the National Accreditation Committee (KAN) as accreditation body, LV-LK and LP-PHPL as verification bodies, and civil-society organisations as independent monitors. A geospatial chain runs from SIPUHH (log-level geotagging at harvest) through SILK (legality and export documentation) to SIMONTANA (national forest monitoring, ~97 % accuracy per FAO Forest Resources Assessment). QR-coded export documents allow buyers to verify producer, exporter, licensing and forest origin

instantly. Through bilateral arrangements and the EU FLEGT VPA, SVLK functions as the “passport” for Indonesian timber to regulated markets.

- **Institutional architecture matters as much as the platform itself.** Both presenters emphasised the importance of national-level government collaboration, of starting from existing data and processes (rather than from scratch) and of building incrementally. Both treated smallholders as the foundation, not the afterthought, and stressed the need for simple tools, easy onboarding, transparency, privacy protection and secure cross-platform data exchange.

“Smallholders are the foundation of the supply chain ecosystem. We need to provide awareness training, simple tools and an easy onboarding process to build trust and create participation.”

— Dr. Theeraya Mayakul, Faculty of Engineering, Mahidol University

3. Regional expert panel discussion

Moderated by **Mr. Mathieu Lamolle (ITC, EUDR focal point)**, the panel brought four sector perspectives: timber from Indonesia (Mr. Agus Setyarso, INSTIPER Yogyakarta), palm oil and rubber from Malaysia (Ms. Smita Jairam, European Forest Institute Asia Regional Office), coffee from Ethiopia (Mr. Henok Alemayehu, Vulcan Digital Technologies), and rubber from Thailand (Mrs. Bunyanuch Sriboonkeaw, Rubber Authority of Thailand).

Key findings

- **Timber (Setyarso).** Robust traceability begins with mapping the full ecosystem of timber origins — state forests, plantations, community forests, conversion land. Indonesia applies *differentiated* standards by source type (state forest, community forest, SMEs), all legally binding through regulation — there is no one-size-fits-all standard. Cross-ministerial coordination (Forestry, Industry, Trade, Finance) is essential, and Indonesia’s separation of functions through binding regulation removes the need for ad-hoc transactions between actors. Verification is operator-based rather than shipment-based, and independent third-party verification (with civil-society monitoring) is non-negotiable.
- **Palm oil and rubber, Malaysia (Jairam).** The Malaysian palm-oil sector has been working on sustainability and deforestation-free production for 10–15 years. The MSPO standard, mandatory from 2020 (revised 2022), covers the full supply chain including smallholders grouped in Sustainable Palm Oil Clusters of 700–2,000 farmers and — critically from 2025 — traders and dealers, who route up to 90 % of smallholder volume to mills and had historically refused to share traceability data. MSPO certification does *not* equate to EUDR compliance (EUDR does not recognise certification) but can support and demonstrate due diligence; the remaining gap is the plot polygon for smallholders above the 4-hectare EUDR threshold. Legality — not geolocation — is often the harder data point: smallholders without formal land grants may rely on village-head or long-house-head recognition letters, as practised in Sarawak.
- **Coffee, Ethiopia (Alemayehu).** The Ethiopian Coffee Traceability Management System (ECTMS) is built around a unique Producer ID with QR code, linking each farmer’s profile, mapped farm polygons and deforestation status. The QR approach was deliberately designed for a context where not every farmer has a smartphone. The most important impact is on farmers themselves:

smallholders previously operating outside any digital system become digitally visible and connected to the formal supply chain.

- **Rubber, Thailand (Sriboonkeaw).** RAOOT's mission spans the full rubber value chain. Operational work underway includes cleaning up internal data systems and connecting them with forestry-system data (legal status, maps, verification); channelling smallholder sales through registered cooperatives that trade via the Thai Rubber Trade Platform, with full traceability back to plantation of origin; and providing deforestation checks to farmers. A pilot Thai Rubber Traceability Standard — aligned with GAP, FSC, PEFC and EUDR, and free of charge for farmers — is planned for July or August 2026. RAOOT has been working directly with farmers on data management since 2018, illustrating the long lead time required.

“Traceability is not only about tracking the product. It is really about building trust in the data behind the product.”

— Mr. Henok Alemayehu, Vulcan Digital Technologies, Ethiopia

Summarizing the panel, **Mr. Mathieu Lamolle** drew out the convergence across four very different sectors and contexts: technology alone is not enough; operationalisation difficulties cluster around geolocation data, legality, verification cost, interoperability and smallholder inclusion; and countries do not need to start from zero — regional experience is genuinely transferable across Thailand, Indonesia, Malaysia and Ethiopia.

“Traceability is not only about technology. It is also about governance, coordination, building trust and collaboration between the actors.”

— Mr. Mathieu Lamolle, Senior Advisor and EUDR focal point, ITC

4. Breakout room discussions

Three parallel breakout rooms were convened. Rooms 1 and 3 were conducted in Thai with consecutive interpretation; Room 2 was conducted in English.

Room 1 — Readiness and challenges

Three concerns emerged. First, forest-land deeds in Thailand may overlap with other land categories and could push rubber and other agricultural plots into high-risk EUDR categories — clarity on the underlying land-deed framework remains incomplete. Second, where Thai supply chain actors do not place products directly on the EU market, they are not legally obliged to submit the Due Diligence Statement but should be prepared to support EU operator with data that they need; the practical implications of this division of responsibility need further clarification. Third, the informality question raised by Dr. Schubert and left open: to what extent does the Thai private sector encounter informality in supply chains, and how is informal-sector information converted into evidence usable by EU operators?

Room 2 — Data collection and traceability

The group concluded that the principal challenges around data and traceability are not technical but institutional, legal and operational. Geolocation and plot-level data remain difficult to collect and verify, but legality of land use is harder still — in several Thai contexts the producer may be authorised to farm a plot without being the legal landowner¹ (for example, when the land belongs to a relative). Inter-organisational collaboration is often limited to high-level MOUs without operational engagement of the technical teams inside government; private-sector data exists (audits, due-diligence records, supplier records) but is fragmented and hard to share. Data ownership, governance and privacy were identified as the core unresolved questions: interoperability cannot be achieved without addressing them first.

“An MOU at the government level is just a piece of paper. You need operational-level coordination — engagement of the technical teams within the government, the data managers and the data scientists.”

— Gregory Sampson, Solutions Architect, International Trade Centre, Breakout Room 2

Room 3 — Roles and collaboration

Four perspectives were exchanged. ACFS reported being well aware of EUDR/CSDDD and ready to act, but underlined the need for strong top-down political will (including from the Prime Minister’s office) to give agencies a clear mandate. RAOT noted that its role spans the full rubber chain but focuses on farmers and mid-stream actors (downstream is largely controlled by foreign investors); government-to-government data sharing — including with Dr. Mayakul’s platform — is working well; the greater concern lies on the private-sector side, which has limited access to some government datasets. OAE / DOAE collects and verifies farmer-registration data and can check overlap with forest areas, but farmer registration is voluntary. A palm-oil private-sector representative joined as an observer and referenced a [JRC – Thai joint study \(Khiripet et al., 2026\)](#), publicly available via the Publications Office of the EU, which found 88 % spatial consistency between Thai national forest/land-use maps and the EU Global Forest Cover map.

¹ EUDR Guidance documents clarify that ownership only has to be documented if the national law demands it.